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Manmohan Singh
May 19, 1992

Photograph by
PRASHANT PANJIAR

Then Union finance minister Manmohan Singh prepares for a meeting of chief executives of public sector banks and financial institutions in New Delhi. Fresh from the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis, this was a moment when India's economy was being painstakingly prised open and a state-dominated, risk-averse banking system was being pushed to reinvent itself as the financier of liberalisation

2

Chandra Shekhar
June 26, 1991

Photograph by
PRASHANT PANJIAR

He may have been PM for only four months, but Chandra Shekhar had a decades-long political life. He resigned after the Congress withdrew support to his minority government in March 1991 and, in the following months, spent much of his time relaxing at his sprawling farmhouse in Bhondsi, in the Aravallis near Delhi. Reading, feeding swans and birds and taking long walks filled his days. The 600-acre property in Haryana is now a nature camp

3

P.V. Narasimha Rao
March 22, 1992

Photograph by
SHARAD SAXENA

As home, finance and foreign affairs minister, and later as premier from 1991-1996, P.V. Narasimha Rao distinguished himself. At a cricket match between MPs, however, the erudite politician revealed a chink in his armour: the forward defensive shot to a spinning delivery was not his strongest suit